

CATEGORIES	DESKTOP HARD DRIVES							
Brand	Western Digital	Western Digital	Western Digital	Western Digital	Seagate	Seagate	Hitachi	
Model Name	Velociraptor	Caviar Black	Caviar Green	Caviar Green	Barracuda 7200.12	Barracuda LP	Deskstar	
Model Number	WD6000HLHX	WD1001FALS	WD10EADS	WD10EARS	ST31000528AS	ST2000DL003	HDS723030A-LA640	
Price (₹)	11,650	4,400	2,900	2,900	3,500	5,000	16,000	
Cost Per GB (₹)	20.84	4.72	3.11	3.11	3.76	2.69	5.73	
Grand Total (Out of 100)	74.86	52.1	44.19	44.68	59.78	62.52	71.9	
Performance (Out of 100)	74.86	52.1	44.19	44.68	59.78	62.52	71.9	
Features								
HDD capacity (GB)	558.91	931.51	931.51	931.51	931.51	1858.23	2794.52	
Interface	SATA 3	SATA 2	SATA 2	SATA 2	SATA 2	SATA 3	SATA 3	
Rotational Speed (RPM)	10000	7200	Intellipower	Intellipower	7200	5900	7200	
Buffer Size (MB)	32	32	32	64	32	64	64	
Performance								
HD Tune Pro 4.01								
Average Read / Write (MB/s)	150.2 / 140.6	102.3 / 101.7	89 / 89.4	101 / 94.3	126.6 / 122.3	133.5 / 129.4	154.4 / 152.9	
Read Burst Speed (MBps)	288.2	185.9	200.4	197.1	185.1	246.6	347.1	
Random Access (1MB) Operations per sec (IOPS)								
Read / Write	64 / 80	40 / 51	32 / 40	27 / 16	42 / 48	36 / 31	41 / 52	
Random Access (1MB) Access Time (in ms)								
Read / Write	15 / 12	24 / 19	30 / 24	36 / 59	23 / 20	27 / 31	24 / 18	
SiSoft Sandra 2010								
Drive Index, Read (MB/s)	129.12	88.27	72.83	79	105	106.64	125	
Access Time, read (ms)	6.8	11.83	14.1	10.41	14	17.12	15.31	
Drive Index, Write (MB/s)	130.55	89.57	74.66	79.9	107.32	107.65	145.9	
Access time, write (ms)	2.43	3.87	5.68	19.7	4.5	0.21	3	
Real World Tests (higher is better)								
File Write 8 GB Single File (MB/s)	148.94	102.4	86.23	99.5	120.47	132.12	132.12	
File Write Test Assorted 8 GB File (MB/s)	97.52	74.06	65.01	52.85	89.04	78.76	94.16	
Read Test Single 8 GB File (MB/s)	151.74	101.13	88.08	99.91	122.26	130.03	134.29	
Read Test Assorted 8 GB File (MB/s)	107.78	76.56	65.54	75.15	91.02	95.25	117.02	
Intra Drive Sequential (Read/Write) (MB/s)	42.01	30.8	23.47	25.05	33.57	32	62.06	
Intra Drive Assorted (Read/Write) (MB/s)	44.51	32.89	25.52	25.36	38.28	38.28	51.84	
PhotoShop CS2 (in secs) (lower the better)	37.79	41.4	53.55	64.21	44.66	45.42	27.87	

dows XP, but with a Host bus adaptor (that comes bundled) you can do that on a machine running Windows Vista and up. Also the WD 3 TB drive is a green edition, so as expected we did not get scores as high as the other two 3 TB drives. But will the Black edition of WD 3 TB beat the other two?

We will have to wait and watch for that one.

Verdict

With a spindle speed of 10,000 RPM, it is not possible for any other drive to beat the Velociraptor and it won our Best Performer. However, the scores from Seagate and Hitachi

3 TB drives were quite impressive. Seagate's Barracuda LP ST2000DL003 was adjudged the Best Buy due to its extremely low cost per GB and a decent overall performance. Hitachi Deskstar 3 TB won the Editor's Pick as it was the second best performer and the fastest amongst all 7200 RPM drives.

LAPTOP DRIVES

We received around eight drives in this segment from Seagate, WD and Hitachi, with 750GB being the maximum capacity. There was a good mix of drives here. From the high performance Black editions, to the value oriented drives to one hybrid drive. You no longer have to